

BOOK STUDY • YEARS 5-6

R.J. PALACIO



MY READING WORKBOOK

Wonder

Ten weeks with August, Via and everyone who chooses kind

Name _____

Class _____ Teacher _____



WELCOME, READER

Your first term at Beecher Prep starts here



August Pullman is starting a real school for the first time in Year 5. Over the next ten weeks you'll follow his story — and the people around him — answer questions, make projects and show what you've learned. Keep this workbook safe — it's your record of the whole term!

How every week works



Monday

Teacher Read



Tuesday

Group Read



Wednesday

Teacher Read



Thursday

Group Read



Friday

Quiz day

My reading journey Colour a star each time you finish a week.



Week 1

Meeting Auggie



Week 2

Choose Kind



Week 3

Halloween



Week 4

Via's World



Week 5

Jack's Choice



Week 6

Switching Tables



Week 7

Growing Up



Week 8

Miranda's Secret



Week 9

The Ending



Week 10

Final Project & Celebration

How I check my learning

Whenever you see these three circles, colour the one that shows where you are right now. It's okay to be at "Not yet" — that's how learning starts!



Not yet



Working towards



Achieved

BEFORE & AFTER

Me as a reader

Fill in the **Start** column in Week 1 and the **End** column in Week 10. Colour one circle in each: ● Not yet · ● Working towards · ● Achieved

I CAN...

START (WEEK 1) END (WEEK 10)

R1 I can explain a big idea from the story and back it up with something that happened in the book.

☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐

R2 I can notice how the author wrote the book and explain how it makes the reader think or feel.

☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐

R3 I can use reading strategies and link what happened earlier in the book to what happens later.

☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐

R4 I can share a clear idea or opinion and give reasons to support it.

☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐

R5 I can choose the right kind of writing and words for the job (like a diary, a poster or a script).

☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐

R6 I can plan my work, improve it using feedback, and complete tasks confidently.

☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐

R7 I can listen to my group, take turns, and build on other people's ideas.

☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐

R8 I can use clues in the story to work out things the author doesn't tell me directly.

☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐

R9 I can share my ideas and do my part in group work.

☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐

R10 I can connect the book's message about choosing kind to my own life.

☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐

One thing I want to get better at as a reader:



WE ARE LEARNING TO

Identify how a character's perspective shapes how a story is told, and infer a character's feelings from what they say and don't say



SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

I can describe August's feelings about starting school and give evidence from the text; I can make a prediction based on clues in the story.



MONDAY • TEACHER READ

Ordinary → Christopher's House

August introduces himself; "ordinary" vs. extraordinary

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

If a genie granted you one wish, what would it be — and why? Do you think everyone's answer would be different?



COMPREHENSION

Why does August say he's "not an ordinary kid" but also feels ordinary inside?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What does this tell us about the difference between how people see us and how we see ourselves?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write 3 sentences about something people might misjudge about you before they get to know you.



TUESDAY · GROUP READ

Driving → Nice Mrs. Garcia

The school tour is arranged; Mum's nerves

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

How would you feel meeting a brand-new school and brand-new people for the very first time, aged 10?



COMPREHENSION

Why is August's mum being so protective before the school tour?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What clues tell us Mr. Tushman is trying to make August feel comfortable?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Describe one adult in your life who makes you feel safe when you're nervous, and how they do it.



WEDNESDAY • TEACHER READ

Jack Will, Julian, and Charlotte → The Deal

Meeting Jack, Julian and Charlotte; “the deal”

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

If you had to show a new student around your school, what three things would you point out first?



COMPREHENSION

What is “the deal” Mr. Tushman makes, and why might that be a smart plan — or an unfair one?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Compare Jack, Julian, and Charlotte's first reactions to August — what's different about each?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Predict which of the three kids will become August's real friend. Give one clue from the text to back up your guess.



THURSDAY • GROUP READ

Home → Locks

The night before school; the combination lock

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Think of your own first day at a new place (school, club, team). What worried you most?



COMPREHENSION

Why might August feel both excited and terrified on the night before school?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What does the “combination lock” scene reveal about how nervous he is?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write a short diary entry as August, the night before his first day.



WEEK 1 • PROJECT MENU

Choose one project

Tick the project you choose. Use the success criteria to guide your work.

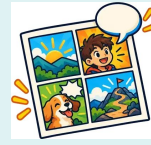


POSTER

Poster

Design a “Welcome to Beecher Prep” poster from Mr. Tushman's office, including at least 3 things a new student should know.

☐ I chose this project



COMIC STRIP

Comic strip

6-panel comic showing August's morning routine before his first day of school.

☐ I chose this project



DRAMA

Drama scene

Act out the car ride to school (Driving) in groups of 3 — August, Mum, Dad — showing the mixed emotions.

☐ I chose this project



JOURNAL

Journal reflection

Write a letter from August to his future self, to be read on his last day of Year 5.

☐ I chose this project

My plan — what I will make

What I need



FRIDAY · QUIZ DAY

Week 1 Quiz

20 questions on Ordinary → Locks

Score ____ / 20

- 1 What does August say makes him “ordinary”?
- 2 How many surgeries has August had by the story's start?
- 3 Why has August never been to a real school before?
- 4 Who is Christopher?
- 5 What game did August and Christopher love playing together?
- 6 What school is August about to start at?
- 7 What joke does August's dad make before the school visit?
- 8 Who works the front desk and everyone calls “Mrs. G”?
- 9 Name the three students Mr. Tushman picks to show August around.
- 10 What is “the deal” Mr. Tushman makes with the three students?
- 11 Which of the three seems most reluctant or awkward about meeting August?

- 12** What does August worry about most on the night before school starts?
-
- 13** What object does August struggle with the night before school (mentioned in “Locks”)?
-
- 14** Inference: Why might August's parents have waited until Year 5 (age 10) to send him to school?
-
- 15** Inference: What does it suggest about August's character that he still makes jokes with his dad despite being nervous?
-
- 16** Vocabulary: What does “petrified” mean, as August uses it about starting school?
-
- 17** August has an older sister named Via.
☐ True ☐ False
- 18** Why do you think the author chose to start the book from August's own point of view?
-
- 19** In your own words, what is “The Deal” really asking the three students to do, and why might that be hard for a Year 5 student?
-
- 20** Reflection: In your own words, describe how August might be feeling as he walks into Beecher Prep for the very first time.
-

My Week 1 check-in

I can describe August's feelings about starting school and give evidence from the text; I can make a prediction based on clues in the story.



Not yet



Working towards

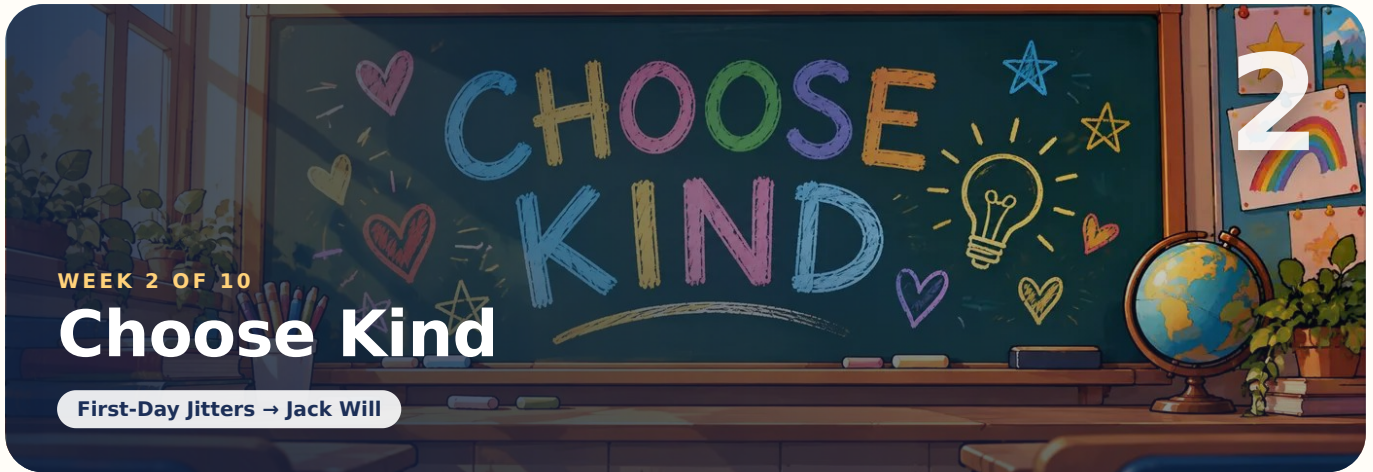


Achieved

The most important thing that happened in the story this week was...



Now colour star 1 in your reading journey!



WE ARE LEARNING TO

Infer how setting and social dynamics (like seating at lunch) reveal character relationships



SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

I can explain why August finds lunchtime difficult and identify the message behind Mr. Browne's precepts.



MONDAY • TEACHER READ

First-Day Jitters → Around the Room

First day; the classroom stares

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Describe a time you walked into a room and felt like everyone was looking at you.



COMPREHENSION

What does August notice first when he walks into the classroom?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why do you think the author includes so much detail about people's reactions/stares?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a rule you'd want a whole school to follow, and why.



TUESDAY • GROUP READ

Lamb to the Slaughter → Choose Kind

Mr Browne's precepts; "choose kind"

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

What do you think the saying "choose kind" means in your own words?



COMPREHENSION

What is Mr. Browne's "precept," and why does he ask the class to write their own each month?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why might "Lamb to the Slaughter" be a scary chapter title for August's first day?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write your own class precept for this month — a short saying about how to treat others.



WEDNESDAY • TEACHER READ

Lunch → The Summer Table

Lunch; choosing a table to sit at

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Think about your own school's lunchroom. How do people usually choose where to sit?



COMPREHENSION

Why is choosing where to sit at lunch such a big deal for August?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What does “The Summer Table” symbolise?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Describe a time you sat somewhere new (a table, a bus seat, a mat spot) and how it felt.



THURSDAY • GROUP READ

One to Ten → Jack Will (the chapter)

Rating the day 1-10; Jack Will becomes a friend

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

On a scale of 1-10, how “bad” do you think a day can really get before it's actually okay again?



COMPREHENSION

Why does August rate his days on a scale of 1 to 10?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What does his friendship with Jack Will seem to be turning into?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Rate your best and worst school day ever (1-10) and explain why.



WEEK 2 • PROJECT MENU

Choose one project

Tick the project you choose. Use the success criteria to guide your work.



POSTER

Poster

Design an illustrated poster of Mr. Browne's precepts wall — include the “Choose Kind” precept plus 2 more the class invents.

☐ I chose this project



COMIC STRIP

Comic strip

Show August's 1–10 rating system as a comic, with one panel for a “1” day and one for a “10” day.

☐ I chose this project



DRAMA

Drama scene

Role-play the lunchroom scene — practise showing “unspoken rules” through body language, no dialogue needed.

☐ I chose this project



JOURNAL

Journal reflection

Write about a time you chose to be kind even though it was hard, or a time you wish you had.

☐ I chose this project

My plan — what I will make

What I need



FRIDAY • QUIZ DAY
Week 2 Quiz

20 questions on First-Day Jitters → Jack Will

Score ____ / 20

- 1 What does August notice as he first enters his classroom?
- 2 Who is the English teacher who introduces “precepts”?
- 3 What is a “precept,” according to Mr. Browne?
- 4 What is the class's September precept?

- 5 Where does August end up sitting at lunch on his first day?
- 6 What is “the summer table”?

- 7 What rating system does August use to describe his days?
- 8 Which student does August start to become real friends with?
- 9 How does Jack behave differently towards August compared to Julian?

10 Inference: Why might August avoid sitting in the middle of the lunchroom?

11 Inference: What does the precept “choose kind” suggest about the difference between being right and being kind?

12 Vocabulary: What does “lamb to the slaughter” mean as an expression?

13 August immediately makes lots of friends on his first day.

☐ True ☐ False

14 Why do you think the author includes Mr. Browne's precepts throughout the whole book?

15 What does it mean that August “rates” his days like a diary?

16 Short answer: Why might starting the term with “Choose Kind” as a class rule set the tone for the whole year?

17 What small kindness does Jack Will show August that stands out this week?

18 Inference: Why might August feel it's safer to “rate” his day than to talk about his feelings directly?

- 19** What is one thing that makes August's first day a “good” moment despite the hard parts?
- 20** In your own words, describe the “unwritten rules” of a school lunchroom that August has to learn fast.
-

My Week 2 check-in

I can explain why August finds lunchtime difficult and identify the message behind Mr. Browne's precepts.



Not yet



Working towards



Achieved

The most important thing that happened in the story this week was...



Now colour star 2 in your reading journey!



WE ARE LEARNING TO

Compare how the same events look different depending on whose point of view we're reading from



SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

I can explain why the author switches narrators to Via, and identify at least one new fact we learn about August from her perspective.



MONDAY • TEACHER READ

Wake Me Up when September Ends → Mr. Browne's October Precept

Halloween approaches; the perfect hiding costume

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

What's your favourite thing about Halloween, and why do you think people love dressing up?



COMPREHENSION

Why might Halloween be extra complicated for August compared to other kids?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why might Halloween be extra complicated for August compared to other kids?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

If you designed the “perfect” Halloween costume for yourself, what would it be and why?



TUESDAY • GROUP READ

Apples → Halloween

The Bleeding Scream costume; overhearing Jack

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Have you ever overheard something you weren't meant to hear? How did it make you feel?



COMPREHENSION

What does August overhear on Halloween, and how does it change how he feels about Jack Will?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why is this such a turning point in the story?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a time someone said something (kindly or unkindly) that you weren't meant to hear.



WEDNESDAY • TEACHER READ

School Pictures → The Bleeding Scream

Coping after Halloween; trust is broken

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

How do you think it feels to see your own photo when you're not happy with how you look?



COMPREHENSION

How does August cope after what happened on Halloween?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What does “The Bleeding Scream” costume incident reveal about how people react to August when they don't realise he's nearby?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write a short message of encouragement you'd send August after this tough week.



THURSDAY • GROUP READ

Names (end Part One) → A Tour of the Galaxy (start Part Two: Via)

Part One ends; Via begins narrating

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Whose voice do you think we'll hear from next, now that Part One is over? Why might the author want to tell part of the story through someone else's eyes?



COMPREHENSION

What new information do we learn about August's family from Via's opening chapter?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

How does Via describe her relationship with her brother?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write 3 things you think Via might find hard about being August's older sister — things August might not even notice.



WEEK 3 • PROJECT MENU

Choose one project

Tick the project you choose. Use the success criteria to guide your work.



POSTER

Poster

Design a “Wanted: Kindness” Halloween-themed poster warning against the kind of unkindness Jack’s friends showed.

☐ I chose this project



COMIC STRIP

Comic strip

Illustrate the moment August overhears the conversation on Halloween — show his costume, the setting, and his changing expression.

☐ I chose this project



DRAMA

Drama scene

Perform a short scene from Via’s point of view, showing a moment where she has to explain her brother to someone new.

☐ I chose this project



JOURNAL

Journal reflection

Write a diary entry as Via, describing what it’s like to be “the sister of the kid everyone stares at.”

☐ I chose this project

My plan — what I will make

What I need



FRIDAY · QUIZ DAY

Week 3 Quiz

20 questions on Wake Me Up When September Ends → A Tour of the Galaxy

Score ____ / 20

- 1 What does August wear for Halloween that lets him feel “invisible”?
- 2 What does August overhear on Halloween that upsets him deeply?

- 3 Who is August upset with after Halloween?
- 4 What happens to August and Jack's friendship after this?
- 5 What is Mr. Browne's October precept about?

- 6 Who narrates Part Two of the book?
- 7 What is the title of Via's opening chapter?
- 8 According to Via, how has her family's attention often been focused?
- 9 What does Via say she sometimes feels compared to August?
- 10 Inference: Why might August choose a costume that completely hides his face for Halloween?

- 11 **Inference:** What does the timing of the Halloween conversation (August in costume, unrecognised) reveal about how differently Jack acts around August vs. when he thinks August can't hear?
-
- 12 **Vocabulary:** What does it mean to feel “invisible,” as August does in his costume?
- 13 **August enjoys Halloween because it's one of the only days people don't react to his face.**
☐ True ☐ False
- 14 **Why might the author choose to reveal Jack's unkind comment right after a rare “good” day for August?**
- 15 **What new perspective on family life do we get once Via starts narrating?**
- 16 **Short answer:** Why do you think Via hasn't told her parents how she really feels about always coming second?
-
- 17 **What is the “Punnett Square” she later studies in science hinting at, thematically?**
-
- 18 **Inference:** How might August's trust in people change after the Halloween incident?
-
- 19 **What does it show about August's character that he still goes trick-or-treating despite what happened?**
-

20

In your own words, compare August's and Via's biggest worries this week.

My Week 3 check-in

I can explain why the author switches narrators to Via, and identify at least one new fact we learn about August from her perspective.



Not yet



Working towards



Achieved

The most important thing that happened in the story this week was...



Now colour star 3 in your reading journey!



WE ARE LEARNING TO

Identify cause and effect in a story, and explain how a character's actions affect others around them



SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

I can explain what “The Plague” refers to and why it affects how other kids treat August's friends.



MONDAY • TEACHER READ

Before August → August Through the Peephole

Via's “peephole” memory of before August

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Do you think it's possible to love someone and still sometimes feel frustrated by how much attention they get? Why?



COMPREHENSION

What do we learn about Via's feelings before August was born?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

How does the “peephole” image work as a metaphor for how Via sees her family?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about someone in your life who takes up “a lot of space” in a good way, and how that makes you feel.



TUESDAY • GROUP READ

High School → After School

Via starts high school; a fresh start

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

What are you most looking forward to (or nervous about) when you eventually go to high school/intermediate?



COMPREHENSION

How is Via's high school experience different from August's at Beecher?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why might Via choose to keep her old friendships from before secret in some ways?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a “fresh start” you'd like to have and what you'd do differently.



WEDNESDAY • TEACHER READ

The Padawan Bites the Dust → Breakfast

The Padawan nickname; breakfast tension

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

What's a nickname you have (or would want) and what does it mean?



COMPREHENSION

Why is the “Padawan” nickname significant to August and Jack's friendship?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What tension is building at the family breakfast table?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a nickname that means something special to you or a friend.



THURSDAY • GROUP READ

Genetics 101 → Out with the Old (end Part Two) + Weird Kids (start Part Three: Summer)

Genetics class; Summer chooses to sit with August

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

We are about to meet a brand-new narrator called Summer. What do you predict her connection to August might be?



COMPREHENSION

What does Via learn in science class that connects to her own family?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why does Summer choose to sit with August — what does this tell us about her character?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a time you chose to sit/stand with someone who was on their own, or a time someone did that for you.



WEEK 4 • PROJECT MENU

Choose one project

Tick the project you choose. Use the success criteria to guide your work.



POSTER

Poster

Create a “Meet the Narrators” poster mapping every narrator so far (August, Via, Summer) with one fact and one feeling for each.

☐ I chose this project



COMIC STRIP

Comic strip

Illustrate Via's “peephole” memory of watching her family focus on August as a baby.

☐ I chose this project



DRAMA

Drama scene

Act out the breakfast table scene, showing the difference between how August and Via each want to talk about their day.

☐ I chose this project



JOURNAL

Journal reflection

Write from Summer's point of view — why she decides to sit with August at lunch on the very first day.

☐ I chose this project

My plan — what I will make

What I need



FRIDAY · QUIZ DAY

Week 4 Quiz

20 questions on Before August → Weird Kids

Score ____ / 20

- 1 What nickname does Jack give August, referencing Star Wars?
- 2 What subject does Via study that links to her family?
- 3 What does Via discover or reflect on in her genetics class?

- 4 What does Via decide about her old best friend Miranda around this time?
- 5 Who is the third narrator introduced in Part Three?
- 6 What is the name of Part Three?
- 7 Why does Summer choose to sit with August at the “summer table”?

- 8 What does “The Plague” refer to?

- 9 Who does August believe started “The Plague” rumour?
- 10 How does August feel about “The Plague”?

11 Inference: Why might Via feel it's easier to start high school where nobody knows about August?

12 Inference: What does the fact that Summer isn't scared to be August's friend suggest about her character compared to other students?

13 Vocabulary: What does “contagious” mean, and why is it an unfair word to use about August?

14 Summer is friends with August because a teacher told her to be.

☐ True ☐ False

15 Why do you think the author gave Via her own narrated section instead of only telling the story through August?

16 Short answer: Explain in your own words what “The Plague” reveals about how rumours spread in a school.

17 What does the title “Out with the Old” suggest is happening in Via's life?

18 Inference: Why might August not tell his parents about “The Plague” straight away?

19 Compare Jack Will and Summer's kindness towards August — how are they different?

20 In your own words, why might real friendship (like Summer's) matter more to August than popularity?

My Week 4 check-in

I can explain what “The Plague” refers to and why it affects how other kids treat August’s friends.



Not yet



Working towards



Achieved

The most important thing that happened in the story this week was...



Now colour star 4 in your reading journey!



WE ARE LEARNING TO

Explore how guilt and regret motivate a character's choices



SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

I can explain why Jack feels guilty and describe what he does to try to make things right.



MONDAY · TEACHER READ

The Call → Four Things

Jack's mum makes him call August to apologise

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Have you ever done or said something you instantly regretted? What did you do next?



COMPREHENSION

Why does Jack's mum make him call August?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What does Jack decide to do differently after Halloween?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a time you had to apologise for something. How did you feel before and after?



TUESDAY · GROUP READ

Ex-Friends → Fortune Favors the Bold

Jack fights Julian; ex-friends and consequences

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

What would you do if your friends started treating your best friend badly — would you speak up?



COMPREHENSION

What happens between Jack and Julian's group now that Jack has changed sides?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why does Jack think “fortune favours the bold”?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a time you had to choose between fitting in and doing what you believed was right.



WEDNESDAY · TEACHER READ

Private School → Detention

Detention; was it worth it?

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

What do you think it takes real courage to stand up for someone, even if it costs you something?



COMPREHENSION

What happens between Jack and Julian that leads to detention?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why might Jack feel it was worth it?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a moment of real courage you've seen (in real life, a book, or a movie).



THURSDAY · GROUP READ

Season's Greetings → The War

The "war" between friend groups; texts and sides

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

What does it feel like when a whole friend group takes sides against you?



COMPREHENSION

How does the “war” between groups of kids affect August and Jack at school?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What role does social media/texting play in this part of the story?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about the effect that unkind messages (online or on paper) can have, even if “it was just a joke.”



WEEK 5 · PROJECT MENU

Choose one project

Tick the project you choose. Use the success criteria to guide your work.



POSTER

Poster

Design a “Fortune Favours the Bold” poster celebrating an act of courage/standing up for someone.

☐ I chose this project



COMIC STRIP

Comic strip

Illustrate the moment Jack defends August against Julian — show the build-up, the action, and the consequence.

☐ I chose this project



DRAMA

Drama scene

Role-play “The Call” — Jack on the phone trying to apologise to August, showing awkwardness turning into honesty.

☐ I chose this project



JOURNAL

Journal reflection

Write a letter from Jack to August, explaining why he acted the way he did and how he plans to make it right.

☐ I chose this project

My plan — what I will make

What I need



FRIDAY · QUIZ DAY

Week 5 Quiz

20 questions on The Call → The War

Score ____ / 20

- 1 Who narrates Part Four?
- 2 Why does Jack's mum make him call August?

- 3 How does Jack feel after Halloween, according to his own narration?
- 4 What does Jack decide to do once school starts again?
- 5 Who does Jack get into a physical fight with, defending August?
- 6 What punishment does Jack get for the fight?
- 7 What does “ex-friends” refer to in this part of the book?

- 8 What does Julian's group start doing to Jack once he defends August?
- 9 What technology is used to spread unkindness in this part of the story?
- 10 Inference: Why might Jack feel that standing up for August was “worth it” even though he lost friends?

- 11** Inference: What does Jack's willingness to fight for August suggest has changed in how he sees him?
-
- 12** Vocabulary: What does the saying “fortune favours the bold” mean?
-
- 13** Jack apologises to August and their friendship is fully repaired straight away with no tension at all.
- ☐ True ☐ False
- 14** Why do you think the author chose to show this part of the story from Jack's perspective rather than August's?
-
- 15** Short answer: In your own words, why is it sometimes harder to apologise to a friend than to a stranger?
-
- 16** What does “the war” suggest about how divided the students have become?
-
- 17** Inference: What risk does Jack take by choosing to be August's friend publicly again?
-
- 18** What does Jack's mum's involvement suggest about the role adults can play in helping kids make things right?
-
- 19** Compare how Jack acts around Julian's group versus how he acts with August one-on-one.
-

20

In your own words, what lesson might Jack have learned by the end of this part?

My Week 5 check-in

I can explain why Jack feels guilty and describe what he does to try to make things right.



Not yet



Working towards



Achieved

The most important thing that happened in the story this week was...



Now colour star 5 in your reading journey!



WE ARE LEARNING TO

Recognise how small choices (like who you sit with) can carry big social meaning



SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

I can explain the significance of “switching tables” and describe a new character’s role in the story.



MONDAY • TEACHER READ

Switching Tables → Why I Didn't Sit with August the (end Part Four)

Jack switches tables at lunch

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Why do you think where someone sits at lunch can matter so much in a school?



COMPREHENSION

What does “switching tables” represent for Jack and August’s friendship?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why might it take courage to do something so small?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a small action that actually made a big difference to someone.



TUESDAY · GROUP READ

Olivia's Brother → Our Town

Justin meets Via's family; Our Town rehearsals begin

Date



BEFORE WE READ

If you were about to meet your friend's sibling for the first time, what would you want to know about them beforehand?



COMPREHENSION

Who is Justin, and how is he connected to Via?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What is “Our Town” and why does it matter to this part of the story?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about someone you've met through a friend or family member who became important to you.



WEDNESDAY • TEACHER READ

Ladybug → The Bus Stop

The Ladybug memory; two worlds intersect

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

What's something small and ordinary that has ended up being one of your happiest memories?



COMPREHENSION

What does the “Ladybug” moment reveal about Via and Justin's relationship?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

How does August's world intersect with Via's here?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Describe a small, ordinary moment that turned into a happy memory for you.



THURSDAY • GROUP READ

Rehearsal → The Universe (end Part Five)

Rehearsal nerves; Part Five ends

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Have you ever been part of a performance (school play, sports game, concert)?

How did it feel leading up to it?



COMPREHENSION

What play is Via rehearsing for, and why might it matter that August will be watching?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What does Justin come to understand about August by the end of this part?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a time you were nervous before a performance or big moment — what helped you get through it?



WEEK 6 • PROJECT MENU

Choose one project

Tick the project you choose. Use the success criteria to guide your work.



POSTER

Poster

Design a “Save the Date” poster for Via’s school play, “Our Town.”

☐ I chose this project



COMIC STRIP

Comic strip

Illustrate Jack switching tables to sit with August — show the reactions of everyone around them.

☐ I chose this project



DRAMA

Drama scene

Perform a short scene from “Our Town” style theatre — simple, everyday dialogue between two characters.

☐ I chose this project



JOURNAL

Journal reflection

Write as Justin, describing his first impressions of meeting August, Via’s little brother.

☐ I chose this project

My plan — what I will make

What I need



FRIDAY • QUIZ DAY

Week 6 Quiz

20 questions on Switching Tables → The Universe

Score ____ / 20

- 1 What big, small action does Jack do that surprises everyone at lunch?
- 2 Who narrates Part Five?
- 3 Who is Justin in relation to Via?
- 4 What play is Via performing in?
- 5 What does Justin start to notice about August as he gets to know the family?

- 6 Where does the chapter “The Bus Stop” take place, and what happens there?

- 7 What is “Ladybug” a reference to?

- 8 What does Justin come to understand by the end of Part Five?

- 9 Inference: Why might Jack switching tables mean more than just “sitting somewhere different”?

- 10 Inference: Why might the author introduce Justin's outside perspective at this point in the story?
-
- 11 Vocabulary: What does it mean to have “loyalty” to a friend, as Jack shows here?
- 12 Justin has known August's family for many years before this part of the book.
- ☐ True ☐ False
- 13 Why do you think Via chose to perform in a play at this point in the story?
-
- 14 Short answer: In your own words, explain why “switching tables” is used as this chapter's title instead of something bigger.
-
- 15 What risk might Jack still be taking, even now, by sitting with August?
- 16 Inference: How might August feel, watching Via succeed in something that's entirely her own?
- 17 What does the title “Our Town” suggest about the play's themes (community, ordinary life)?
-
- 18 Compare how Justin sees August with how strangers at school often react to him.
-

19 Why might it matter to the story that we now have several different narrators?

20 In your own words, what has changed about August's friendships since the start of the book?

My Week 6 check-in

I can explain the significance of “switching tables” and describe a new character's role in the story.



Not yet



Working towards

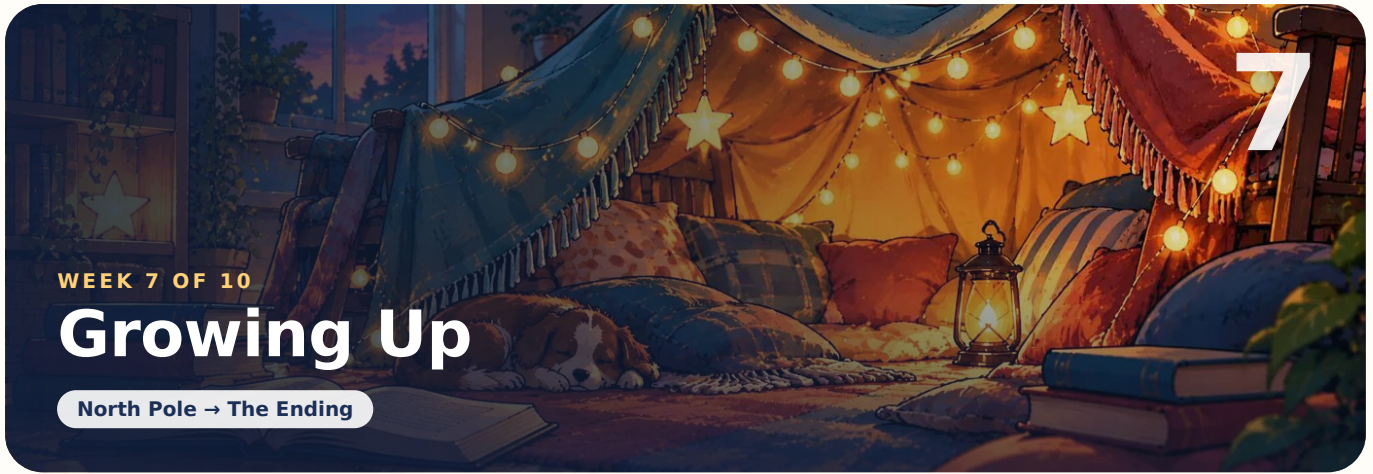


Achieved

The most important thing that happened in the story this week was...



Now colour star 6 in your reading journey!



WEEK 7 OF 10

Growing Up

North Pole → The Ending



WE ARE LEARNING TO

Identify how family relationships change and deepen over the course of a story



SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

I can explain what Via's "secret" is and describe how August reacts to change within his family.



MONDAY • TEACHER READ

North Pole → Lobot

North Pole traditions; things start to change

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

What's a family tradition you have, and what would it feel like if it suddenly changed?



COMPREHENSION

What does "North Pole" refer to in the family's traditions?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why might August feel uneasy about things changing?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a family tradition that means a lot to you.



TUESDAY • GROUP READ

Hearing Brightly → My Cave

Hearing Brightly; August's private "cave"

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Do you have a "cave" — a place you go to feel calm or think? Describe it.



COMPREHENSION

What does the "Hearing Brightly" incident reveal about August's confidence/friendships now?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What does August's "cave" symbolise?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Draw or describe your own personal "cave" — your calm space and why it matters to you.



WEDNESDAY • TEACHER READ

Goodbye → Heaven

Daisy dies; the family grieves together

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

How do people usually cope with losing something or someone important to them (a pet, a person, a stage of life)?



COMPREHENSION

What loss does August experience in this section?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

How does he process his grief?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write a kind message to someone who has experienced a loss.



THURSDAY • GROUP READ

Understudy → The Ending (end Part Six)

August becomes Via's understudy; "The Ending"

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Would you rather be the star of a show or the "understudy" who's ready just in case? Why?



COMPREHENSION

What role does August end up playing in Via's school play, and why does this matter so much?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What does “The Ending” of Part Six suggest is coming next?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a time you stepped up when someone unexpectedly needed you.



WEEK 7 • PROJECT MENU

Choose one project

Tick the project you choose. Use the success criteria to guide your work.



POSTER

Poster

Design a “Memory Wall” poster celebrating the family tradition mentioned in “North Pole.”

☐ I chose this project



COMIC STRIP

Comic strip

Illustrate August’s “cave” — his safe, calm space — as a comic showing what he does there.

☐ I chose this project



DRAMA

Drama scene

Perform the “Understudy” moment, where August unexpectedly plays a role in Via’s play.

☐ I chose this project



JOURNAL

Journal reflection

Write about someone or something you have said goodbye to, and what you learned from it.

☐ I chose this project

My plan — what I will make

What I need



FRIDAY • QUIZ DAY
Week 7 Quiz

20 questions on North Pole → The Ending

Score ____ / 20

1 Who narrates Part Six?

2 What does “North Pole” refer to for August's family?

3 What incident happens in “Hearing Brightly”?

4 What is August's “cave”?

5 What does August lose in “Goodbye”?

6 How does August cope with this loss?

7 What does “Daisy's Toys” chapter deal with?

8 What surprising role does August end up playing related to Via's play?

9 Why is it significant that August gets involved in Via's play?

10 Inference: Why might August's "cave" be an important detail to include in the story?

11 Inference: How might losing Daisy affect August differently than it affects the rest of the family?

12 Vocabulary: What does "understudy" mean in theatre?

13 August refuses to get involved in Via's school play at all.

☐ True ☐ False

14 Why do you think the author placed a family loss (Daisy) so close to a moment of growth (the play)?

15 Short answer: In your own words, why might "having a cave" (a private safe space) be healthy for anyone, not just August?

16 What does the chapter title "The Ending" hint about the direction of the story?

17 Inference: How has August's confidence changed since Week 1 of this unit?

18 Compare August's family traditions with your own — what's similar, what's different?

- 19** Why might it matter that the reader sees this loss and recovery from August's own point of view rather than someone else's?
-

- 20** Predict: What do you think Part Seven (narrated by Miranda) will reveal, based on what you know so far?
-

My Week 7 check-in

I can explain what Via's "secret" is and describe how August reacts to change within his family.



Not yet



Working towards



Achieved

The most important thing that happened in the story this week was...



Now colour star 7 in your reading journey!



WE ARE LEARNING TO

Analyse why a character might tell a lie, and predict the consequences of that choice



SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

I can explain Miranda's "camp lie" and describe how the setting of the nature retreat builds tension.



MONDAY • TEACHER READ

Camp Lies → What I Miss Most

Miranda's camp lie; what she misses most

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

Why do people sometimes tell small lies to seem more interesting or important?



COMPREHENSION

Who is Miranda, and what lie does she tell at camp?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What does she say she misses most, and why is that surprising?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a time you (or someone you know) told a small lie and what happened afterwards.



TUESDAY · GROUP READ

School → Extraordinary, but No One There to See

Date _____

Miranda and Via drift apart; unnoticed achievements



BEFORE WE READ

Have you ever felt like you did something great but nobody was there to notice?



COMPREHENSION

How has Miranda's friendship with Via changed?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why does the chapter title suggest something “extraordinary” went unnoticed?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a personal achievement that felt extraordinary to you, even if barely anyone saw it.



WEDNESDAY • TEACHER READ

The Performance → After the Show (end Part Seven)

Date _____

Via's performance; Miranda comes clean



BEFORE WE READ

What do you think it means to finally be honest with someone after keeping a secret for a long time?



COMPREHENSION

What happens during Via's performance?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

How does Miranda's arc conclude?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about the value of being honest, even when it's hard.



THURSDAY • GROUP READ

The Fifth-Grade Nature Retreat → Packing (start Part Eight: August)

Date _____

Packing for the Fifth-Grade Nature Retreat



BEFORE WE READ

If you were going on a school camp for a week, what would you be most excited or nervous about?



COMPREHENSION

What is the Nature Retreat, and why is it a big deal for August?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What does his packing list tell us about how he's feeling?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Make a packing list for your ideal school camp, and explain your top 3 must-haves.



WEEK 8 · PROJECT MENU

Choose one project

Tick the project you choose. Use the success criteria to guide your work.



POSTER

Poster

Design an honesty campaign poster: "The Truth About Little Lies," inspired by Miranda's story.

☐ I chose this project



COMIC STRIP

Comic strip

Illustrate Miranda's "camp lie" moment and its consequences.

☐ I chose this project



DRAMA

Drama scene

Role-play a conversation where a character decides to finally tell the truth after keeping a secret.

☐ I chose this project



JOURNAL

Journal reflection

Write your own "packing list and worries" diary entry as if you were August, about to leave for the Nature Retreat.

☐ I chose this project

My plan — what I will make

What I need



FRIDAY · QUIZ DAY
Week 8 Quiz

20 questions on Camp Lies → Packing

Score ____ / 20

- 1 Who narrates Part Seven?
- 2 What lie does Miranda tell at summer camp?

- 3 Why might Miranda have told this lie?

- 4 What does Miranda say she misses most?

- 5 How has Miranda and Via's friendship changed by this point?
- 6 What performance does Via take part in that Miranda attends?
- 7 What does Miranda do at/after the performance?
- 8 What is the "Fifth-Grade Nature Retreat"?
- 9 Why might this retreat be a significant/nerve-wracking event for August specifically?

10 What does August pack, and what might this reveal about him?

11 Inference: Why does Miranda's lie eventually make her feel worse rather than better?

12 Inference: What might “Extraordinary, but No One There to See” suggest about how Miranda feels about her own life?

13 Vocabulary: What does it mean to feel “extraordinary”?

14 Miranda's home life is shown to be simple and happy.

☐ True ☐ False

15 Why do you think the author included Miranda's perspective, even though she's not part of August's immediate family?

16 Short answer: In your own words, why might telling the truth about something eventually feel like a relief?

17 Predict: Based on the retreat setting and camp themes so far, what kind of event do you think might happen next?

18 Inference: Why might going on a retreat/camp be an important “growing up” milestone in the story?

- 19 Compare Miranda's way of coping with problems (lying) to Jack's way (owning up) from earlier weeks.

- 20 What questions do you have heading into the final part of the book?

My Week 8 check-in

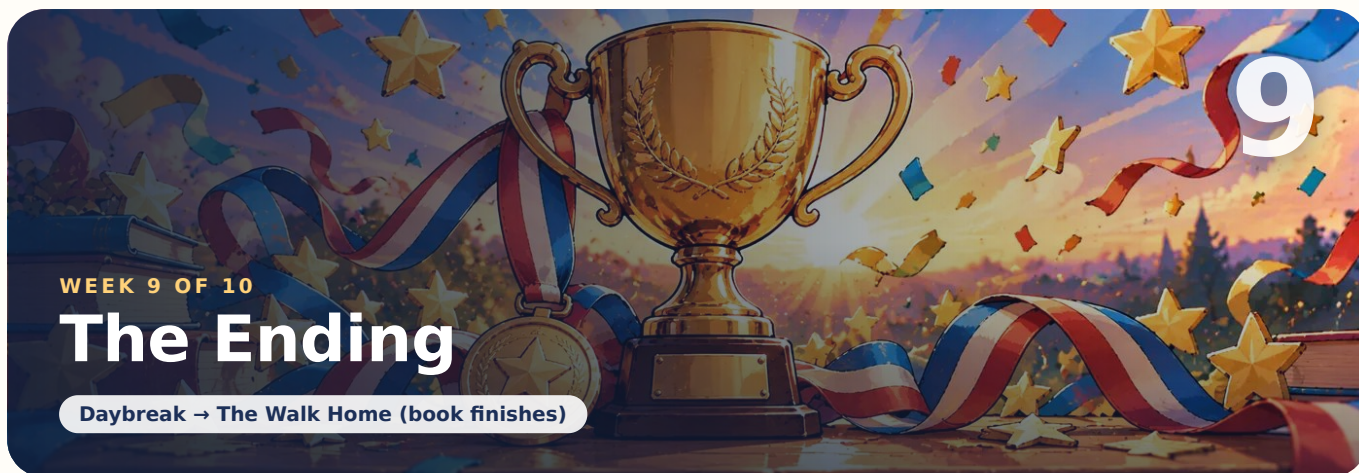
I can explain Miranda's "camp lie" and describe how the setting of the nature retreat builds tension.

☐ Not yet ☐ Working towards ☐ Achieved

The most important thing that happened in the story this week was...



Now colour star 8 in your reading journey!



WE ARE LEARNING TO

Identify the climax of a story and reflect on how a character has changed from the beginning to the end



SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

I can describe the crisis at the retreat and explain how the community responds; I can summarise the key message of the book's ending.



MONDAY • TEACHER READ

Daybreak → The Woods Are Alive

Settling in at camp; the woods at night

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

What's the scariest or most exciting thing that could happen on a night camp-out in the woods?



COMPREHENSION

What tension is building as the kids settle in for the night at camp?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why might unfamiliar surroundings make everyone (not just August) feel uneasy?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a time you felt genuinely scared, and how you (or someone) helped calm things down.



TUESDAY • GROUP READ

Alien → The Emperor's Guard

The confrontation in the woods; friends stand together

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

If your group of friends were suddenly in danger, what do you think you'd do?



COMPREHENSION

What frightening event happens to August and his friends in the woods?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

How do the other boys (including some who weren't his friends before) react?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write about a moment when someone unexpected stood up for you, or you stood up for someone else.



WEDNESDAY • TEACHER READ

Sleep → The Last Precept

The community responds; “The Last Precept”

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

How do you think a scary shared experience might change how a group of people see each other afterwards?



COMPREHENSION

How does the school community respond once everyone is safe?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

What is “The Last Precept,” and how does it sum up the whole book's message?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write your own “last precept” — the one big lesson you'd want people to remember from this book.



THURSDAY • GROUP READ

The Drop-Off → The Walk Home (finish the book)

Awards Day; “The Walk Home” — the book finishes

Date _____



BEFORE WE READ

How do you think August's very first day of school (Week 1) compares to how his year is ending now?



COMPREHENSION

What happens at the Awards ceremony?



INFERENCE — READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Why is it meaningful that the whole community — not just August's family — celebrates him by the end?



GO-AWAY REFLECTION

Write a full reflection: What is the biggest lesson “Wonder” has taught you about kindness, courage, or seeing people for who they really are?



WEEK 9 • PROJECT MENU

Choose one project

Tick the project you choose. Use the success criteria to guide your work.



POSTER

Poster

Design an “Awards Day” poster celebrating a value (kindness, courage, friendship) rather than just achievement.

☐ I chose this project



COMIC STRIP

Comic strip

Illustrate the climax in the woods — build tension across the panels, then show the moment friends stand together.

☐ I chose this project



DRAMA

Drama scene

Perform the Awards Day scene, including how the audience reacts to August receiving recognition.

☐ I chose this project



JOURNAL

Journal reflection

Write a full letter to August, from you, sharing what his story has taught you.

☐ I chose this project

My plan — what I will make

What I need



FRIDAY • QUIZ DAY

Week 9 Quiz

20 questions on Daybreak → The Walk Home (book finishes)

Score ____ / 20

- 1 What event happens to August and his cabin-mates in the woods at night?

- 2 Who steps in to help/defend August during this event?

- 3 How does this shared crisis change the way some classmates see August?

- 4 What is “The Last Precept” the book ends on?

- 5 What happens at the Awards ceremony at the end of the book?

- 6 Who gives a speech at the Awards ceremony that especially honours August?

- 7 How does the school community as a whole treat August by the end of the book, compared to the beginning?

- 8 What is the title of the very final chapter?

- 9 Who walks home with August's family at the very end?
-
- 10 Inference: Why might the author choose a dangerous night in the woods as the story's climax?
-
- 11 Inference: How has Jack's role in August's life come full circle by the end of the book?
-
- 12 Vocabulary: What does “precept” mean, as used throughout the whole book?
-
- 13 By the end of the book, August still feels like an outsider at school.
- ☐ True ☐ False
- 14 Why do you think the author ends the book with a celebration/award rather than just the crisis in the woods?
-
- 15 Short answer: In your own words, what is the single biggest lesson “Wonder” teaches about how we treat people who are different from us?
-
- 16 Which character do you think changed the most across the whole book, and why?
-
- 17 Looking back at Week 1's quiz, how has your understanding of August changed by the end of the book?
-

18 Why might the author have used so many different narrators across the whole book?

19 What does “choosing kind” actually look like in action, based on examples from the whole book?

20 If you could ask R.J. Palacio (the author) one question about the book, what would it be?

My Week 9 check-in

I can describe the crisis at the retreat and explain how the community responds; I can summarise the key message of the book's ending.



Not yet



Working towards



Achieved

The most important thing that happened in the story this week was...



Now colour star 9 in your reading journey!



WEEK 10 • THE FINALE

Final Project & Celebration

No new reading



OPTION 1

“Choose Kind” Campaign

Design and pitch a whole-school kindness campaign (posters, a short video script, a pledge wall) inspired by the book's precepts.

☐ We chose this



OPTION 2

Wonder the Musical/Play — Extended Scene

Write and perform an extended dramatic scene (5+ minutes) either continuing the story or dramatising a moment from a new narrator's point of view (e.g. Julian, told with empathy).

☐ We chose this

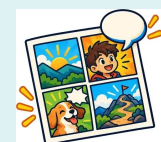


OPTION 3

Character Case File

Create an in-depth multimedia profile (poster + written report + comic panels) tracking one character's journey and change across the whole book, using evidence/quotes (paraphrased, not copied) from every part they appear in.

☐ We chose this



OPTION 4

“Precepts for Our Class” Book

Design and illustrate an original class book of 12 precepts (one per month of the year), each with an illustration and a real-life example of how to live it out — bound into a class anthology.

☐ We chose this

Our project plan

Our big idea — what will our project show about *Wonder*?

Our team & roles

NAME

MY JOB IN THE GROUP

MONDAY

☐ Choose & Plan

Choose your project, plan (storyboard/outline), gather resources, and assign group roles.

Today I...

TUESDAY

☐ Main Production

Main production time — writing, drawing, rehearsing, building.

Today I...

WEDNESDAY

☐ Finishing Touches

Finishing touches, rehearsal/polish, prepare for presenting.

Today I...

Things we need



THURSDAY • GALLERY WALK

Glow & Grow

Cut out a slip and leave it with another group's project.



✦ Glow

One thing that really shone...

↑ Grow

One thing to think about next time...



✦ Glow

One thing that really shone...

↑ Grow

One thing to think about next time...



✦ Glow

One thing that really shone...

↑ Grow

One thing to think about next time...



✦ Glow

One thing that really shone...

↑ Grow

One thing to think about next time...



FRIDAY • CHOOSE KIND DAY

The precept I'll carry forward

What will you remember from this book for a long time?

My favourite moment in the whole book was...

If I could say one thing to August, it would be...

Don't forget!



Colour star 10 in your reading journey, and fill in the "End" column on your Me as a reader page.



Choose kind. Always.

August learned that being seen for who you really are starts with someone choosing to look past the surface.

Now it's your precept to carry.